

CRT OR JRT- UWH(united way of hyderabad)

WELS FARGO-USA(dial your village)

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COGNIZENT SALES FORCE-32 MODULE PROGRAM (SAP-system application and products),industrial visit by cognizent

ACCENTURE

EMERTXE-reservation only for girls

RUBICON

Corporate Responsibility

1. Introduction

- **Corporate Responsibility (CR)**, also called **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)**, refers to an organization's duty to act ethically, contribute to sustainable development, and balance profit with people and the planet.
- It is not only about philanthropy but about embedding responsibility into everyday operations, governance, and communication.

2. Circulating Vision and Mission Statements to Employees

- Vision and mission statements act as the **moral compass** for employees.
- Circulating them ensures alignment of personal goals with organizational purpose.
- Internal communication (newsletters, workshops, town halls) reinforces the values.

Example:

- **Google** communicates its mission “to organize the world’s information and make it universally accessible and useful” to employees through on boarding, training, and culture-building activities.
- **Infosys** highlights “powered by intellect, driven by values,” reminding employees to maintain integrity in client dealings.

Impact: Employees become brand ambassadors when they embody the vision.

3. Ethical Practices

- Ethical business practices include **fair trade, anti-corruption, transparency, accountability, and inclusivity**.
- Ensures compliance with laws and enhances long-term reputation.

Example:

- **Tata Steel** pioneered ethical practices by refusing to compromise on worker safety and environmental responsibility even when it cost profits.
- **Johnson & Johnson**’s Credo emphasizes responsibility to customers, employees, and society—guiding its decisions for decades.

4. Human Rights

- Corporates must respect human rights such as equality, dignity, and freedom of expression.
- Includes preventing discrimination, harassment, and exploitation.

Example:

- **Microsoft** has policies promoting workplace diversity and inclusive hiring, ensuring equal opportunity.
- **Unilever** has global human rights commitments—safe workplaces, freedom of association, gender equality in leadership.

5. Labour Rights

- Fair wages, safe working conditions, reasonable working hours, right to unionize, and elimination of child/forced labor.
- Compliance with ILO (International Labour Organization) standards is essential.

Example:

- **Nike** faced backlash in the 1990s for sweatshop labor; since then, it invested in strict supplier codes of conduct and independent audits.

- **Infosys** ensures employees' rights with fair contracts, employee grievance systems, and strong HR policies.

6. Environment

- Corporates are expected to minimize carbon footprint, reduce waste, and adopt sustainable production.
- Eco-friendly practices strengthen brand image and attract eco-conscious customers.

Example:

- **Tesla** promotes electric vehicles, directly addressing environmental sustainability.
- **ITC Limited (India)** is “carbon positive, water positive, and solid waste recycling positive” through large-scale sustainable initiatives.
- **Apple** has pledged to be 100% carbon neutral across its entire supply chain by 2030.

7. Governance

- Refers to how a company is directed, controlled, and held accountable.
- Principles: transparency, independence of board, shareholder rights, ethical auditing.

Example:

- **Infosys** set global standards in corporate governance in India, emphasizing disclosure and independence of directors.
- The **Enron scandal (2001)** highlighted how lack of governance and manipulation of financial reporting can destroy trust and wealth.

8. Moral and Ethical Debates Surrounding Corporate Responsibility

- **Profit vs. Responsibility Debate:** Should businesses only maximize shareholder profits (Milton Friedman's view) or serve stakeholders (stakeholder theory)?
- **Greenwashing:** Companies exaggerating their eco-friendly initiatives for publicity.
 - *Ex: Volkswagen's “Dieselgate” scandal—falsifying emissions tests while advertising “clean diesel.”*
- **Data Privacy vs. Innovation:** Companies using customer data responsibly vs. exploiting it for profit.
 - *Ex: Facebook–Cambridge Analytica controversy raised debates on privacy.*

Lesson: Responsibility should be genuine, not cosmetic.

9. Public Relations (PR) and Corporate Responsibility

- PR is the **bridge between the company and its stakeholders** (customers, employees, investors, media, community).
- Ethical PR ensures **transparency, credibility, and long-term trust** rather than image management alone.

Example:

- During the 1982 Tylenol crisis, **Johnson & Johnson** used PR to communicate openly with the public, recalled products immediately, and rebuilt trust.
- **Patagonia** actively uses PR to highlight its eco-friendly supply chain and social activism, reinforcing credibility.

10. Building Trust with Stakeholders

- Trust is built when corporate responsibility is visible in **actions, not just words**.
- Stakeholders include employees, customers, investors, suppliers, community, and government.
- Requires **consistency, transparency, responsiveness, and accountability**.

Example:

- **Tata Group** enjoys massive stakeholder trust because of its century-old commitment to ethics, philanthropy, and nation-building.
- **Starbucks** builds trust by offering ethically sourced coffee (Fair Trade) and supporting farmers.
- **Wipro** in India emphasizes sustainability and transparent stakeholder engagement in its CSR reports.

Summary (Key Takeaways)

1. **Corporate Responsibility** is more than charity—it's about embedding ethics, rights, governance, and sustainability in daily operations.
2. Vision and mission statements should be *lived*, not just displayed.
3. Human rights, labour rights, and environmental care are non-negotiable pillars.
4. Governance failures can destroy companies (Enron, Satyam), while ethical governance builds longevity (Infosys, Tata).
5. Moral debates like *profit vs. responsibility* and *greenwashing* continue, but authenticity wins in the long run.
6. PR is not just image management—it's a tool to communicate responsibility and build credibility.
7. Trust with stakeholders = health + wealth + sustainability of the organization.

Corporate Ethics and Business Etiquette

1. Corporate Ethics

- Corporate ethics refers to the **moral principles and standards** guiding business conduct.
- It ensures **fairness, integrity, transparency, and accountability** in all professional interactions.

Examples of Corporate Ethics:

- **Infosys** is known for ethical governance and transparency in client dealings.
- **Johnson & Johnson's Credo** emphasizes ethical responsibility towards customers, employees, and society.

2. Business Etiquette

Business etiquette is the **set of socially and professionally accepted behaviors** that reflect respect, professionalism, and cultural sensitivity.

It covers **communication, body language, appearance, and workplace manners**.

3. Integrity in Communication

- Integrity means being **truthful, consistent, and respectful** in messages.
- Avoid exaggeration, hidden agendas, or misleading information.
- Builds **trust with clients, employees, and stakeholders**.

Example:

- **Satya Nadella (Microsoft CEO)** emphasizes clear, transparent communication—leading to a culture of openness.

4. Harmful Practices and Communication Breakdown

- Withholding information (lack of transparency).
- Gossip or grapevine (unofficial, often harmful communication).
- Aggressive or disrespectful tone with clients.
- Ignoring cultural sensitivities in global business.

Example:

- United Airlines faced global backlash in 2017 for poor communication and mishandling of a passenger crisis—damaging its reputation.

5. Teaching How to Deal with Tough Clients (Through Soft Skills)

- **Listen actively:** Let clients express frustrations.
- **Empathize:** Acknowledge their concern.
- **Stay calm & polite:** Do not mirror aggression.
- **Offer solutions, not excuses.**
- **Follow up** to rebuild trust.

Example Soft Skill Response:

- Instead of saying: *“That’s not my problem.”*
- Say: *“I understand your concern. Let me see how best we can address it.”*

6. Body Language

- Maintain eye contact → shows confidence.
- Open posture (avoid crossed arms) → shows receptiveness.
- Firm but not crushing handshake.
- Smile appropriately → conveys warmth.

Example: In job interviews, 55% of impression comes from body language (psychology studies show).

7. Grooming

- Professional attire aligned with organizational culture.
- Personal hygiene (clean shoes, tidy hair, minimal fragrance).
- Avoid flashy accessories in formal settings.

Example: IT companies like TCS, Infosys, and Deloitte emphasize *“smart business casuals”* for daily office wear.

8. Introducing Oneself

- Stand straight, smile, and maintain eye contact.
- Use full name, position, and a polite phrase.
- Keep it short and confident.

Example:

- *“Good morning, I’m Ramesh Kumar, Project Lead at Infosys. It’s a pleasure to meet you.”*

9. Use of Polite Language

- Replace commanding phrases with polite alternatives:
 - “Do this immediately” → “*Could you please complete this by today?*”
 - “That’s wrong” → “*Let’s look at another approach.*”
- Always say “*Please, Thank you, Sorry, Excuse me.*”

10. Avoiding Grapevine and Card Pushing

- **Grapevine:** Unofficial, informal, often harmful gossip.
 - Reduces trust, creates conflict.
- **Card pushing:** Over-aggressive self-promotion (handing out business cards without building rapport).
- Instead: build **genuine relationships** through respectful conversations.

11. Etiquette in E-mail, Mobile, and Telephone

E-mail Etiquette

- Use clear subject lines.
- Keep tone professional and concise.
- Avoid slang, emoticons, or ALL CAPS.
- Always proofread before sending.
- Use official signatures.

Example:

“Pls send asap. Urgnt!!”

“Dear Mr. Rao, Could you please share the report by 4 PM today? Regards, Anil Kumar.”

Mobile Etiquette

- Keep phone on silent/vibrate in meetings.
- Avoid taking long personal calls in office space.
- Respond politely to missed calls with a callback.

Telephone Etiquette

- Answer within 3 rings.
- Greet politely with your name and organization.
- Speak clearly, don’t eat or multitask while on call.
- End conversation courteously.

Example:

- *“Good morning, this is Priya from Wipro HR Department. How may I assist you?”*

Summary (Key Takeaways)

1. Corporate ethics ensures fairness and trust in business.
2. Business etiquette strengthens professionalism and relationships.
3. Integrity in communication prevents misunderstandings and builds credibility.
4. Soft skills (empathy, patience, problem-solving) are vital in handling tough clients.
5. Body language, grooming, and polite speech shape first impressions.
6. Avoid grapevine gossip and self-centered networking.
7. Digital and telephonic etiquette reflect corporate discipline.